



END OF AN ERA

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The Premier League, for most of the 21st century, has been defined by eras — the Alex Ferguson era, the Jose Mourinho era, and now, the Pep Guardiola era. Out of the many players who made their name amid these managerial eras, Kevin De Bruyne (**above**) stands out as one of the best ever in the league.

With 16 titles at City and 106 goals to his name, the Belgian talisman announced that he would be leaving the club at the end of the season. Naturally, expectations were sky-high for his last Manchester derby against United. However, when the two arch-rivals locked horns for the 196th time, the encounter ended up being anything but memorable.

A dull goalless draw at Old Trafford was an accurate

representation of both teams' shoddy form this season, with defending champion City sitting fifth while United reeled in 13th after the final whistle.

Meanwhile, champion-elect Liverpool's title parade was delayed after it suffered a surprise 3-2 defeat against Fulham. Sloppy defending allowed Ryan Sessegnon, Alex Iwobi and Rodrigo Muniz to score within 14 minutes in the first half and hand Arne Slot only his second league defeat of the season.

However, the Reds will take comfort in the fact that their closest challenger, Arsenal, also faltered in its title bid after being held to a 1-1 draw by Everton. The result leaves Arsenal trailing Liverpool by 11 points, with seven games left to play.

At the other end of the table, Southampton set an unwanted record by becoming the earliest team to be relegated from the Premier League after losing 1-3 to Tottenham Hotspur.

Having registered only two wins